



Inside macOS Tahoe

Apple's boldest Mac upgrade in a decade

Yashraj Verma | editor@digit.in

From the original 1984 Macintosh that introduced the world to graphical user interfaces, to OS X's revolutionary Aqua design that made computers feel alive, Apple's desktop operating systems have consistently redefined what we expect from our digital workspaces.

More than an operating system, macOS is the soul of the Mac experience. Now, with macOS Tahoe 26, Apple has probably delivered its most ambitious visual transformation since the leap from the Mac OS to OS X.

But as stunning as it looks, this update comes with some hard truths that many users won't want to hear.

A fresh new design

The star of the show is undoubtedly Apple's new semi-transparent aesthetic — 'Liquid Glass' — which is now unified across all their operating systems. The interface features translucency aplenty, refined docks and toolbars, and a transparent menu bar that makes the desktop feel larger.

It's undeniably gorgeous, but I'll be honest — some folks in my office



have been quick to point out how this reminds them of Windows Aero from way back in 2007. In 2025, that's either delightfully retro or painfully dated, depending on your perspective.

The revamped Control Center lets you arrange items for quick access, while icons, folders, and widgets can sync with your wallpaper's colour scheme. Folder customisation adds a personal touch. Yet, the heavy reliance on transparency can feel distracting for some, and the Aero comparison might not sit well with Apple purists.

Spotlight on Spotlight

Spotlight's biggest update ever steals the show. It ranks search results by relevance, supports quick keys for targeted searches (RIP Alfred), and even acts as a clipboard manager (finally).

You can browse vaguely when you're unsure what you're looking for which is a boon for scatterbrained creatives. Natural language queries like "PDF from Abhishek last week" now work. You can even trigger Shortcuts from Spotlight. This makes Spotlight not just a search tool but a productivity hub, though it risks overwhelming users with its newfound versatility.

Dedicated Games app, finally

It finally happened: macOS has a Games app. It curates your library, suggests new titles, and play with friends with in-game chats — all without exiting.

Apple is also introducing the next generation of Metal with macOS Tahoe named Metal 4. It will allow developers to offer new and better graphics in their games using upscaling, high-quality visuals, and ray tracing. A lot of high-end titles including Cyberpunk 2077 are making their way to macOS.

Taking Shortcuts finally good on Mac

Shortcuts finally got more attention they deserve. It now feels like a proper Mac app on Tahoe, transforming from a mobile port into an automation powerhouse on Mac. This seems a lot to take in but it's rather very simple in real life. The new trigger-based system lets you create complex workflows that respond to emails, text messages, or time-based events.

Where things get really exciting is the Apple Intelligence. Apple demonstrated a lecture recording workflow that automatically ingests audio, feeds it to AI for summarization, and generates a formatted document — all without touching a line of code.

The new Quick Keys feature acts like a short phrase letting you trigger complex Shortcuts with barely a few keystrokes. Combine this with Apple Intelligence, and boom, you now have possibilities that feel almost magical — the kind of easy and seamless automation that makes you wonder how you ever lived without it. **d**